

STANFORD UNIVERSITY

Environmental Health & Safety — Laboratory Safety Program

Incoming Laboratory Relocation — Summary

Hazardous materials requirements for labs relocating to Stanford from other institutions

Last updated: September 15, 2026 |

Prohibitions

- NO hazardous waste of any kind — chemical, biological, radiological, or universal/e-waste — may ever be shipped or transported to Stanford, from any origin, under any circumstance.
- General moving companies and household/commercial movers may NEVER pack, handle, or transport any hazardous material. Only a currently licensed U.S. DOT hazardous materials carrier may transport hazardous materials to Stanford.
- Researchers shall not personally transport any hazardous materials to Stanford in private vehicles or hand-carry onto commercial aircraft.
- Researchers shall not ship hazardous materials to Stanford via the US Postal Service or other commercial carriers without appropriate prior authorization from Stanford. All shipments must comply with applicable regulations and Stanford requirements.
- Stanford does not accept donations, transfers, or gifts of legacy, surplus, expired, or otherwise unwanted chemicals or hazardous materials from any outside institution.

1. What This Covers

Applies to any incoming PI, postdoc, or research group bringing a lab — and any hazardous chemicals, gases, radioactive materials, biological materials, or controlled substances — to any Stanford location from another institution, domestic or international. It extends Stanford's outbound Laboratory Deactivation and Move Guidelines to cover the inbound direction.

2. Before Anything Ships

- PI contacts Stanford home department 4–6 months before arrival.
- Required approvals in place before shipment: radioactive material authorization, IBC biosafety approval, IACUC (if animals), DEA registration transfer, and any import permits.
- Carrier's DOT/IATA hazardous materials credentials verified in writing before packing begins.
- Equipment that contacted hazardous material must be decontaminated and certified clean at the origin institution first.

3. Non-Compliance

Shipments lacking required approvals, containing prohibited waste, or moved by an unlicensed general mover will be refused at the receiving dock at the sender's expense, and may be referred to the Department, the Vice Provost and Dean of Research, and external regulators. Violation penalties assessed by regulatory agencies are the responsibility of the involved Department and/or PI.